

Anna Zhang

annaz94264@gmail.com ♦ (925) 336-2555 ♦ linkedin.com/in/annazhang06 ♦ annazhang006.github.io/portfolio/

EDUCATION

University of California Santa Cruz, Santa Cruz, CA

B.S. Cognitive Science | B.S. Computer Science: Game Design

Expected Graduation June 2028

GPA: 3.81/4.0, **Dean's List:** 2 Quarters

Relevant Coursework: Foundations of Video Game Design, Game Development Experience, Research Methods in Psychology, Programming Abstractions: Python, Applied Discrete Mathematics

RELEVANT PROJECTS

UCSC Mini Campus Explorer - Team Game Project (2025) - *GDevelop, GitHub*

- Defined core product requirements (quest system, NPC interactions) for a team project, translating gameplay goals into scoped, shippable features within a one-quarter timeline
- Ran structured playtests with classmates, informal user research, logged findings as GitHub issues, and prioritized fixes based on player feedback to hit milestone deadlines, an early customer-discovery-to-requirements loop
- Collaborated cross-functionally with designers and developers to scope and build event-based interaction logic against a fixed deadline

PSYC 100 Research Infographic (2025) - *Google Sheets*

- Conducted survey-based market/user research (n=200 college students) and synthesized existing literature to frame original findings — the same discovery-to-insight structure used to ground a product recommendation
- Translated raw survey data into a visual narrative for a non-technical audience, prioritizing the single relationship (extracurriculars vs. academic success) most relevant to the reader

SKILLS

- **Data & Analysis:** Python, C, Excel, Google Sheets, Survey Design, Data Visualization
- **Product & Research:** User Research, Requirements Definition, Competitive/Literature Analysis, Experimental Design, Participant Recruitment, Cross-Functional Collaboration
- **Software:** Canva, WordPress, Word, Excel, Adobe Illustrator, PowerPoint, Google Workspace
- **Language:** Mandarin (Professional Working Fluency)

EXPERIENCE

Santa Cruz Dragon Boat, Santa Cruz, CA

June 2025 – June 2026

Social Chair

- Analyzed engagement data (post reach, follower growth) across Instagram and TikTok to identify which content formats and messaging resonated, and used those insights to redirect content strategy — increasing post reach 80% and follower base 10% in 6 months
- Partnered cross-functionally with the broader team to align creative execution with organizational goals, and independently secured \$600+ in partner support through tailored proposals and relationship-building

College Leadership and Engagement Office, Santa Cruz, CA

September 2026 – Present

Programs Assistant

- Owned the full lifecycle for 10+ campus programs (100–400+ attendees), from requirements through execution.
- Reconciled competing priorities (accessibility, accommodations, engagement) across ResLife, Student Government, and the Provost's Office to scope each event.
- Redesigned program structure to close awareness gaps, then iterated using participant feedback.

Ben Storm Memory Lab, Santa Cruz, CA

March 2025 – Present

Research Assistant

- Coordinated recruitment, session facilitation, and data entry for 100+ participants across 2 studies, maintaining rigorous experimental protocol to ensure clean, usable data
- Attended weekly lab meetings and contributed to review of multiple ongoing project presentations, engaging with research design and methodology decisions across the team's portfolio of studies

White Stag Leadership Academy, Monterey, CA

September 2021 – September 2024

Senior Patrol Counselor; Assistant Senior Patrol Leader; Patrol Counselor

- Delivered 1,400+ volunteer hours a year while maintaining a full academic course load
- Designed and led two week-long leadership camp programs serving 100+ youth participants
- Directed multi-day outdoor experiences, including overnight hikes, leadership games, and team challenges, increasing participant engagement scores by 30% through post-camp surveys
- Managed logistics, resources, and schedules, ensuring on-time delivery of all planned activities per session

ACTIVITIES, & HONORS

- **Presidential Volunteer Service Award (Gold)**, *Recipient* 2022 – 2024
- **Certificate of Merit - Piano Level 10**, *Recipient* May 2022